

Word family: **soar / soars / soared / soaring**

Base word: soar

Forms: soars, soared, soaring

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / adjective through **soaring** (形容詞化用法)

Your sentence:

> “In a city defined by cramped flats, **soaring rents** and limited public space...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **soaring** means **rising very quickly to a very high level**.

So **soaring rents** does not merely mean that rents are expensive. It emphasizes that rents have been **increasing sharply** and have reached very high levels.

繁體中文：***急升的；大幅上漲的；迅速升至很高水平的**

中文翻譯：

> “...cramped flats, **soaring rents** and limited public space...”

「.....狹窄擠迫的住宅、**急升的租金**以及有限的公共空間.....」

Here:

soaring rents = 租金快速而大幅上升

1. **soar = fly high in the air (飛翔) — 高飛；翱翔**

This is the central literal meaning.

Meaning: To fly high in the sky, often smoothly and with little visible effort.

Practice 1

> “An eagle **soared** above the mountains.”

「一隻鷹在群山上空**翱翔**。」

Practice 2

> “Birds **soared** high above the coast.”

「鳥兒在海岸上空高高**飛翔**。」

****soar = 在高空中平穩地飛翔，通常給人輕鬆、自由、持續上升的感覺****

Common subjects:

- * eagle
- * bird
- * glider
- * aircraft

2. ****soar = rise upward rapidly in the air (升空) — 急速上升；升高****

****Soar**** can emphasize upward movement rather than simply staying high.

Practice 3

> “The bird ****soared**** into the sky.”

「那隻鳥迅速**升上天空**。」

Practice 4

> “The glider ****soared**** higher on the warm air currents.”

「滑翔機借助暖氣流**升得更高**。」

****soar = 在空中迅速或持續向上升高****

For strict counting, #1 and #2 belong to the same broad physical-flight branch.

3. ****soar = increase very rapidly to a high level (數字 / 價格) — 飆升；急升****

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 5 — Original

> “Hong Kong has experienced ****soaring rents****.”

「香港面對**急升的租金**。」

Practice 6

> “Energy prices **soared** during the winter.”

「能源價格在冬季**飆升**。」

Practice 7

> “Demand **soared** after the announcement.”

「消息公布後，需求**急升**。」

soar = 價格、成本、需求、數字等在短時間內大幅上升至很高水平

Common:

- * prices soar
- * rents soar
- * costs soar
- * demand soars
- * profits soar
- * temperatures soar

This is one of the strongest figurative senses.

4. **soar** = become dramatically more successful/popular (成功 / 人氣) — 急升；迅速走高

The same upward metaphor can describe popularity, success, ratings, confidence, etc.

Practice 8

> “Her popularity **soared** after the performance.”

「表演後，她的人氣**急升**。」

Practice 9

> “The company’s reputation **soared**.”

「公司的聲譽**大幅提升**。」

soar = 人氣、成功程度、聲望或其他抽象水平迅速提升

For strict counting, I would merge this with Meaning 3 because the underlying concept remains:

> **rise sharply to a much higher level**

5. **spirits soar = become extremely happy/excited (情緒) — 心情飛揚；精神振奮**

Soar can describe a sudden rise in mood or emotion.

Practice 10

> “Her spirits **soared** when she heard the good news.”

「她聽到好消息後，心情頓時**振奮起來**。」

Practice 11

> “My heart **soared** when I saw the result.”

「我看到結果時，心裡頓時**無比雀躍**。」

spirits/heart soar = 情緒突然變得非常高昂、喜悅或振奮

This is a vivid figurative extension of the upward-motion sense.

6. **soar = rise very high physically / tower upward (建築 / 地形) — 高聳；直插高空**

Mountains, towers, buildings, cliffs, etc. can **soar** when they rise impressively high.

Practice 12

> “The mountains **soared** above the valley.”

「群山在山谷上方**高聳入雲**。」

Practice 13

> “Glass towers **soar** above the city.”

「玻璃高樓在城市上方**高高聳立**。」

soar = 建築物、山峰等向上延伸到很高的位置，帶有壯觀、高聳的感覺

This is not literal flying; it describes impressive vertical height.

7. **soaring** = very high / lofty in physical form (形容詞) — 高聳的；極高的

The participle **soaring** often functions like an adjective.

Practice 14

> “The hall has **soaring** ceilings.”

「大廳有**極高的 / 高聳的**天花板。」

Practice 15

> “The cathedral is famous for its **soaring** arches.”

「這座大教堂以**高聳的**拱頂聞名。」

soaring = 向上延伸得非常高，令人產生宏偉、開闊的感覺

This develops from Meaning 6.

8. **soaring** = powerful, expansive, emotionally uplifting music/voice (音樂 / 聲音) — 高亢的；激昂的；氣勢恢宏的

Soaring can describe music, melodies, vocals, or voices that rise strongly and create an expansive emotional effect.

Practice 16

> “The song has a **soaring** chorus.”

「這首歌有一段**高亢激昂**的副歌。」

Practice 17

> “Her **soaring** voice filled the hall.”

「她**高亢而有力量的**歌聲充滿整個大廳。」

soaring = 聲音或旋律高昂、開闊而有強烈感染力的

This is an established artistic extension.

9. **soar** = rise sharply in temperature (溫度) — 急升；飆高

Practice 18

> “Temperatures **soared** above 40°C.”

「氣溫**飆升**至攝氏四十度以上。」

This is not a new meaning. It belongs to the numerical-level branch.

10. **soar** = rise rapidly in number/quantity (數量) — 激增

Practice 19

> “Applications **soared** after the programme became popular.”

「計劃受歡迎後，申請數量**激增**。」

Practice 20

> “Visitor numbers have **soared**.”

「訪客數量**急升**。」

Again, the same underlying meaning as prices/rents.

Related form: **soaring**

Soaring can function as:

Verb participle

> “Prices are soaring.”

「價格正在**急升**。」

Adjective — rapidly rising

> “soaring costs”

「**急升的**成本」

Adjective — physically very high

> “soaring towers”

「**高聳的**塔樓」

Adjective — musically/emotionally expansive

> “a soaring melody”

「**高亢激昂的**旋律」

This is why **soaring** can have quite different Chinese translations while preserving related English imagery.

Related noun use: **soaring**

In aviation, especially gliding, **soaring** can also be a noun referring to the activity of flying using rising air currents.

> “He became interested in **soaring**.”

「他開始對**滑翔飛行**產生興趣。」

This is established but specialist.

Related form: **soarer**

A **soarer** can mean something or someone that soars, but it is rare in general English.

For the practical learner family, I would **not** prioritize it.

Important distinction: **soar vs rise**

rise

is neutral:

> prices rose

****soar****

is much stronger:

> prices soared

****Soar**** implies:

- * rapid increase

- * large increase

- * usually reaching a high level

So:

> rents rose

= 租金上升

> rents soared

= 租金****大幅急升 / 飙升****

Important distinction: ****soar vs climb****

****climb****

often suggests a more gradual increase.

****soar****

suggests a dramatic or rapid increase.

> costs climbed steadily

> costs soared suddenly

There can be overlap.

Important distinction: ****soar vs surge****

****surge****

means a sudden, powerful increase.

****soar****

emphasizes rising rapidly to a high level.

> demand surged

> prices soared

****Surge**** emphasizes the sudden burst; ****soar**** emphasizes the upward trajectory and high level.

Important distinction: ****soar vs skyrocket****

****skyrocket****

is an even more vivid figurative verb meaning rise extremely quickly.

****soar****

is strong but slightly more neutral/formal.

> housing costs soared

> housing costs skyrocketed

Both indicate dramatic increase.

Important distinction: ****soar vs fly****

****fly****

is the general verb for movement through the air.

****soar****

suggests:

* high altitude

* smooth movement

* little apparent effort

* often majestic flight

> birds fly
> eagles soar

Important distinction: **soar vs glide**

glide

emphasizes smooth movement with little effort.

soar

emphasizes height and often upward movement.

A bird can:

> glide downward

but:

> soar upward

There is substantial overlap in aviation/bird contexts.

Important distinction: **soaring vs high**

This matters directly in your passage.

high rents

= rents are expensive.

soaring rents

= rents are **rising rapidly**, usually to very high levels.

So replacing **soaring** with **high** loses the dynamic idea of rapid increase.

Grammar note: **soar** is usually intransitive

Normally:

- > prices soar
- > rents soar
- > birds soar

Not:

- > “They soared the prices.” ❌

To express causation:

- > “They pushed prices higher.”

Grammar note: ****soar to / soar by / soar above****

****soar to + final level****

- > “Prices soared to \$100.”

= 價格飆升至 100 元。

****soar by + amount/percentage****

- > “Prices soared by 30%.”

= 價格飆升了 30%。

****soar above + level/place****

- > “Temperatures soared above 40°C.”

- > “The eagle soared above the mountains.”

Same verb, numerical versus physical context.

Countability note

****Soar**** is overwhelmingly used as a verb.

A noun ****soar**** exists in limited/specialist contexts for an act or period of soaring, but ordinary modern English strongly prefers:

- * soaring
- * flight
- * rise

So I would not prioritize noun **soar** in the learner database.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family is small:

- * **soar**
- * **soars**
- * **soared**
- * **soaring**

The major semantic network is built around one strong image:

> **moving dramatically upward**

From that develop:

- * bird/aircraft flight
- * prices and rents
- * temperatures
- * popularity/reputation
- * mood/spirits
- * high buildings and mountains
- * high, expansive music/voices

The domains should be surfaced, but after the audit most can be merged conservatively because the upward metaphor remains transparent.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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soar — flight	在高空平穩、自由地飛翔 / 翱翔
soar — upward flight	在空中迅速或持續向上升高
soar — price/amount/level	價格、成本、需求、數字等迅速而大幅上升至高水平
soar — success/popularity	人氣、聲望、成功程度等迅速提升
spirits/heart soar	心情突然非常振奮、雀躍
soar — building/mountain	向上延伸得很高；高聳入雲
soaring — architecture	高聳、極高、氣勢宏偉的

soaring — music/voice	高亢、激昂、開闊而有感染力的	
soaring — aviation noun	利用上升氣流進行的滑翔飛行；專門	

For your original sentence

> “In a city defined by cramped flats, **soaring rents** and limited public space...”

The exact meaning is:

****soaring = 租金在一段時間內快速而大幅上升，並達到很高水平****

So:

> ****soaring rents****

= ****急升的租金 / 飆升的租金****

It is significantly stronger than:

> ****high rents****

because ****high**** describes the level, while ****soaring**** describes the ****rapid upward movement****.

For your database, I would count ****4 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****soar****:

1. ****fly/rise high in the air****
2. ****rise very rapidly in amount, price, level, popularity, etc.****
3. ****rise or extend impressively high physically — mountains/buildings****
4. ****figuratively rise emotionally / soaring music or voice****

I would merge rents, prices, temperatures, demand, popularity, and reputation under #2, while keeping ****spirits soar**** and artistic ****soaring voice/melody**** visible as strong figurative extensions.